



EAGLE MOUNTAIN CITY COUNCIL JOINT WORK MEETING – SPECIAL SESSION

Joint Meeting with Eagle Mountain City, the City of
Saratoga Springs, and Fairfield Town

May 21, 2024, 4:00 p.m.
Eagle Mountain City Council Chambers
1650 East Stagecoach Run, Eagle Mountain, Utah 84005

4:00 P.M. SPECIAL SESSION – CITY COUNCIL CHAMBERS

EAGLE MOUNTAIN CITY ELECTED OFFICIALS PRESENT: Mayor Tom Westmoreland, Councilmembers Donna Burnham, Melissa Clark, Jared Gray, Rich Wood, and Brett Wright.

EAGLE MOUNTAIN CITY STAFF PRESENT: Steve Mumford, Interim City Manager; Fionnuala Kofoed, Assistant City Manager/City Recorder; Cliff Strachan, Director of Legislative Affairs; Marcus Draper, City Attorney; Kimberly Ruesch, Finance Director; Tyler Maffitt, Communications Manager; Angela Valenzuela, Human Resource Manager; Natalie Winterton, Grants Coordinator/Management Analyst; Terrence Dela Pena, Finance/Management Analyst; Brandon Larsen, Planning Director; Robert Hobbs, Senior Planner; David Stroud, Senior Planner; Caden Lyon, Planner; Mack Straw, Public Utilities Manager; Zac Hilton, Streets and Storm Drain Manager/Parks and Recreation Manager; Jeff Weber, Fleet and Facilities/Operations Director; Brad Hickman, Public Works Director; and Eric McDowell, Chief Deputy Sheriff.

EAGLE MOUNTAIN CITY STAFF PRESENT ELECTRONICALLY: Elizabeth Fewkes, Recording Secretary; Michele Graves, Library Director; Embret Fossum, Unified Fire Authority Battalion Chief; and Maria Loza, Accountant.

SARATOGA SPRINGS CITY ELECTED OFFICIALS PRESENT ELECTRONICALLY: Mayor Jim Miller, Councilmembers Audrey Barton, Chris Carn, Michael McOmber, Lance Wadman, and Stephen Willden.

SARATOGA SPRINGS CITY STAFF PRESENT ELECTRONICALLY: Mark Christensen, City Manager; Kevin Thurman, City Attorney; and Nicolette Fike, City Recorder.

FAIRFIELD TOWN ELECTED OFFICIALS PRESENT ELECTRONICALLY: Mayor Hollie McKinney, Councilmembers R.L. Panek, Tyler Thomas, and Michael Weber.

FAIRFIELD TOWN STAFF PRESENT ELECTRONICALLY: Stephanie Shelley, Recorder.

CEDAR FORT TOWN ELECTED OFFICIALS PRESENT ELECTRONICALLY: Mayor Wyatt Cook.

ALPINE SCHOOL DISTRICT BOARD MEMBERS: Julie King, and Joilyn Lincoln.

1. CALL TO ORDER

Mayor Westmoreland called the meeting to order at 4:02 p.m.

2. ROLL CALL

3. PRESENTATION – Feasibility Study for The Creation of a New School District, Prepared By LRB Public Finance Advisors

Laura Lewis, Principal/Owner at Lewis, Robertson, and Burningham (LRB) Public Finance Advisors introduced the item.

LRB Vice President Fred Philpot delivered a presentation on the feasibility of creating a new school district in Saratoga Springs, Eagle Mountain, Cedar Fort, and Fairfield, as mandated by Utah Code §53G-3-102(4)(a)(ii). The scope of the feasibility study is within the discretion of the interlocal legislative bodies. The analysis focuses primarily on the financial impacts of creating a new district. The study analyzed key factors such as enrollment, taxable value, and the financial health of various funds within the district.

Enrollment estimates for the new district used FY2023 projected growth from Alpine School District with 24,184 students. This figure is expected to grow annually to reach 29,299 by 2029, representing a gradual increase from 28.56% to 32.56% of the total district population over six years. Taxable values are similarly set to rise, with the new district starting at 20.99% of the total in 2025 and projected to increase to 26.13% by 2029. These figures highlight a robust growth trajectory for both enrollment and taxable values, surpassing the growth rates of the existing and reorganized districts.

The General Fund is expected to encounter initial deficits due to duplicated administrative costs and proportionate allocations based on enrollment, with projections showing deficits decreasing as the taxable value per student grows. The Capital Projects Fund is anticipated to be financially sustainable, potentially enhanced by State support through Foundation programs and Enrollment programs, with an allocated \$65 million to mitigate future debt service costs. The analysis assumes the Capital Projects Fund will have a positive balance with revenues exceeding expenditures and no tax increase for all districts. The Debt Service Fund addresses the management of existing debts and the financial requirements for upcoming capital needs. These capital needs include substantial initial costs for new building construction and facility upgrades, with the assumption of 20% of the debt allocation to the new district as legally mandated. Notably, \$221 million in bonds are proposed for the new district to cover these capital needs.

The financial summary predicts the new district will have a lower taxable value per pupil in the beginning years resulting in lower overall revenues and expense per pupil in funds. However, as the district matures, increased taxable values are expected to gradually offset these financial challenges. The tax impact analysis forecasts a decrease in tax per household over five years, beginning at \$296.19 annually/\$24.68 a month in 2025 and reducing to \$88.34/\$7.36 per month by 2029, illustrating the district's potential to become financially viable over time.

The MGT Study was completed for Alpine School District and recommended a community vote on splitting the district. Mr. Philpot explained that the MGT study used numbers from 2023 and the LRB study used data from the 2024 Alpine School District budget and updated formulas for State funding.

Discussion ensued regarding the difference between the LRB study and the MGT study, the proportionate allocation of existing district facilities and assets as mandated by statute, and the impact of the bond being issued with the new debt service being assumed by the current district before the split, versus being the responsibility of the new district after.

4. ADJOURNMENT

MOTION: *Councilmember Gray moved to adjourn the meeting at 4:55 p.m. Councilmember Wood seconded the motion.*

Donna Burnham	Yes
Melissa Clark	Yes
Jared Gray	Yes
Rich Wood	Yes
Brett Wright	Yes

The motion passed with a unanimous vote.

The meeting was adjourned at 4:55 p.m.


Fionnuala B. Kofoed, MMC
City Recorder

